

Hello.

I'm delighted to share my experience and point of view with you. Let me start by sharing how we align.



CAROL BALES

USER RESEARCH

Alignment with Google



High-impact research manager

I led a high-volume mixed-methods research team for 5 years whose output informed critical product decisions. I implemented standards, improved research reach and provided career coaching for my team, all while building a supportive community.

Experienced strategist, researcher and designer

15+ years experience in UX research and 20 years in UX design, I am comfortable with the creativity and ambiguity of designing new experiences with emerging tech and modes.

Communicating impactful insights

My extensive experience in UX strategy, design and research empower me to communicate complex research insights clearly, shaped to help leadership and teams make better decisions.

Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) and best practices

I'm a strong user advocate, teaching HCI at Georgia State University (as a side gig). I hold a MS in HCI from Georgia Tech, where my research focus was on professional creative design processes.

Strategic alignment with the ELT and stakeholders

At TWC I earned company-wide recognition as a thought leader and as a trusted partner to stakeholders, teams, and leadership. I helped shape business and user goals, planned quarterly goals garnering alignment and go-forward plans.

The Weather Company: Design Research

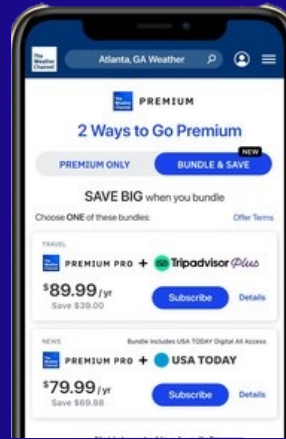


I leveraged long experience in UX by evangelizing human-centered design practices, and continuously executing high-quality, impactful research.



Formative research for wellness forecasts.

I performed multiple iterations of research to uncover user attitudes and needs for wellness information.



Improving purchase process.

Used the RITE method of usability testing to refine a new purchase experience for bundled subscriptions. The results eliminated unforeseen, confusing blockers to the purchase process.



Iterative design validation for novel features.

I executed research to evaluate multiple concepts with content from experts presented in various forms. The winner was developed and released.

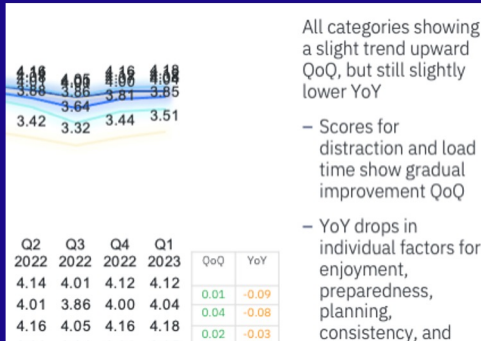
The Weather Company: Leadership & Strategy



Leading research, I achieved widely-recognized impact on the organization by connecting business strategy and research, and by strengthening the research practice and operations.

Strengthened research practice.

I evangelized research from multiple listening channels to new business areas and stakeholders. I hosted a monthly research showcase, introduced a quarterly UX benchmark for success metrics, and oversaw creation of a research repository.



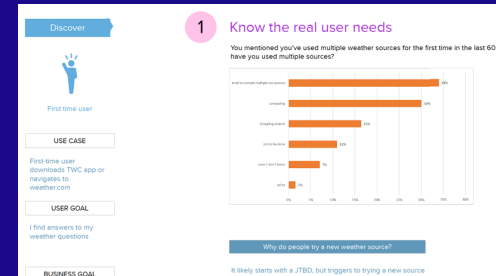
Agile design grounded in research.

I designed a framework in Mural to enable writing user stories that were grounded in Jobs-to-be-Done and reflected both consumer product and ad sales perspectives on the audience.



Research-based customer journey.

I led the effort to craft a customer journey map with Product and Marketing, grounded in understanding of user goals, churn, and weather jobs-to-be-done



Career Highlights



#1 At Brookdale Senior Living, I led the UX effort to **prototype a decision-support tool** to optimize the community selection and move-in processes. I then ran research to validate that the business target of reducing attrition during the sales process was achievable. Brookdale Senior Living (by StellarX)

#2 At Delta Airlines, I ran observational user research with call-center representatives, then with the learnings, prototyped an optimized call-center application to **reduce call-wait and call-processing times**.

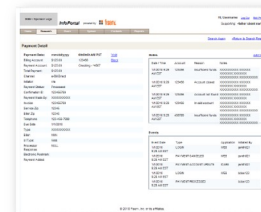
#3 As lead UX and researcher at Fiserv, I **improved the findability of key information by 70%** in their bill-pay call-center application, and triaged issues with the search API for Walmart Money Centers bill payment system.

#4 Through extensive A/B split-testing, I **optimized the hotel search and booking process**, resulting in significant increases in revenue for InterContinental Hotels Group.



Participants were shown 3 views of a payment detail

2. Navigate to a separate page



Several participants initially preferred this view to #1 for clarity and lack of busy-ness.

When prompted to consider that the advantages / disadvantages of navigating away from the search results, participants then preferred either #1 or #3

Some of the brands who've trusted me to impact strategy and improve experiences...





Leadership Guiding Principles

- 1 Take **responsibility**
- 2 Research is most effective when it embraces AND informs the **business strategy**
- 3 Be disciplined AND flexible with **planning**
- 4 Transparent **communications**, two-way dialogue
- 5 Leadership establishes the north-star, then **removes obstacles** from the teams' path
- 6 **Foster leadership** in others by granting decision-making authority and through coaching
- 7 Create a **culture** where people are inspired to succeed



UX Practice Guiding Principles

- 1 Engage with the business and user needs
- 2 Set stakeholder expectations early and often
- 3 Don't overdesign
- 4 Facilitate excellence at every stage
- 5 Tailor the the output to the audience
- 6 Follow through
- 7 Celebrate the wins



Thank you.

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